

Request for Proposal (RFP)

Project Overview

Project Title: 'RFP for 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheet Supply from Buffalo Aluminum Supply to Nexa'

Client: Nexa

Industry: aluminum sheets

Date: October 20, 2025

1. Introduction

Introduction

Nexa is a mid-sized enterprise operating in the aluminum sheets procurement and supply chain management industry. Our business is centered on the procurement of high-quality aluminum sheets, specifically the 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheet, which is a critical material for our operations. Our business model relies heavily on the consistent quality, timely delivery, and competitive pricing of this product.

The business problem we are currently addressing is the need for a reliable and qualified supplier for our 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheet. Our operations are greatly dependent on this product, and any inconsistencies in quality, delays in delivery, or uncompetitive pricing can significantly impact our business performance.

Our strategic goal is to establish a long-term strategic partnership with a supplier who can consistently meet our needs. We have identified Buffalo Aluminum Supply as a potential partner due to their expertise in the aluminum sheets industry. Our desired outcome is to

secure a supply agreement with Buffalo Aluminum Supply to deliver 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheet to our Buffalo, New York location. Our target budget for this partnership is between \$50 and \$700.

In terms of historical context, we are currently in the process of evaluating Buffalo Aluminum Supply based on their expertise and reputation in the aluminum sheets industry. Buffalo Aluminum Supply is a leading supplier of high-grade aluminum sheets, serving various industries in the Buffalo area. We believe that a partnership with them could potentially fulfill our strategic goals and address our current business needs.

2. Scope of Work

Scope of Work

The vendor is expected to deliver the following:

Specific Tasks and Deliverables

The vendor is required to supply 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheets from Buffalo Aluminum Supply, located in Buffalo, NY. The price range per sheet should fall between \$350 and \$500. The vendor is responsible for ensuring the delivery of the product to Buffalo, New York.

Technical Specifications or Required Standards

The product must meet industry-standard specifications and quality requirements. The vendor is expected to adhere to these standards and ensure that the supplied 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheets are in compliance with these specifications.

Required Integrations

The vendor is required to integrate their supply chain with Buffalo Aluminum Supply. More information can be found at <http://www.buffaloaluminumsupply.com>. This integration is

essential for ensuring a smooth and efficient supply of the 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheets.

Quantifiable Performance Metrics

The vendor's performance will be evaluated based on the following key performance indicators:

- 1. On-time delivery to Buffalo, New York.
- 2. Quality compliance rate of greater than 98%.
- 3. Competitive pricing within the range of \$50 to \$700.
- 4. Responsive customer service.

The vendor is expected to maintain regular communication with Buffalo Aluminum Supply and can contact them at contact@buffaloaluminumsupply.com.

Services Needed Beyond Delivery

Beyond the delivery of the 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheets, the vendor is required to maintain a consistent supply of the product. This includes providing regular quality reports to ensure that the product meets the required standards. The vendor is also expected to provide support services as needed to address any issues or concerns related to the product or its delivery.

3. Vendor Qualifications

QUALIFICATIONS

The prospective vendor must meet the following minimum qualifications:

EXPERIENCE: The vendor must demonstrate a proven track record in supplying 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheet or similar products. This experience should be substantiated

with relevant case studies or past projects. For instance, Buffalo Aluminum Supply claims expertise in aluminum sheets, which is a relevant experience.

CERTIFICATIONS: The vendor must possess an ISO 9001 or equivalent quality management certification. This is to ensure that the vendor adheres to internationally recognized quality standards. In addition, industry-specific certifications, as applicable, are also required. These certifications provide assurance of the vendor's competence and professionalism in the industry.

TEAM SKILLS AND DOMAIN EXPERTISE: The vendor's team should have the following skills and domain expertise:

4. Expertise in manufacturing/distributing 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheet: This is critical to ensure the quality and reliability of the product.
5. Quality control and assurance processes: The team should have robust processes in place to maintain the quality of the product.
6. Logistics and supply chain management: The team should be capable of managing the entire supply chain effectively to ensure timely delivery.
7. Ability to deliver to Buffalo, New York: The vendor should have the logistical capability to deliver products to Buffalo, New York.

Technical support and customer service: The vendor should provide excellent technical support and customer service to handle any issues or queries.

COMPLIANCE AND REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS: The vendor must comply with all relevant compliance and regulatory requirements. This is to ensure that the vendor operates within the legal framework and adheres to all necessary regulations.

In summary, the vendor must have relevant experience, necessary certifications, required team skills, and must meet all compliance and regulatory requirements to be considered for this project.

4. Project Timeline

Section IV: Project Timeline

The following timeline provides an overview of the key stages and milestones for the project. Please note that these dates and timeframes are based on our current understanding of the project's requirements and may be subject to change based on the responses received to this RFP.

Project Kickoff: The project will officially commence on October 27, 2025. This will involve an initial meeting to discuss the project's objectives, scope, and deliverables in detail.

Initial Delivery (MVP): The Minimum Viable Product (MVP) should be delivered within 60 days of the project kickoff. This will be a working version of the solution that incorporates the core functionality and features. It will provide a basis for further development and refinement.

Quality Inspection and Acceptance: Upon delivery of the MVP, there will be a quality inspection and acceptance phase. This will take place within 5 business days of delivery. During this phase, the solution will be thoroughly tested to ensure it meets the project's requirements and standards. Any issues or defects identified will need to be addressed promptly.

Final Delivery: The final, fully functional solution should be delivered by January 18, 2026. This will include all features and functionality as per the project's requirements, along with any refinements or improvements identified during the testing phase.

Please note that while we aim to adhere to these timelines as closely as possible, there may be some flexibility depending on the nature of the responses received to this RFP. However, the final delivery date is a hard constraint and must be met. We encourage all potential

vendors to consider this timeline when preparing their proposals.

Milestone	Description	Target Date
Project Kickoff	Initial alignment	October 27, 2025
MVP Delivery	First prototype	Initial delivery: Within 60 days
Testing Phase	QA and user testing	Quality inspection and acceptance within 5 business days of delivery
Final Deployment	Production release	January 18, 2026

5. Evaluation Criteria

Section IV: Evaluation Criteria

The purpose of this section is to outline the criteria by which proposals will be evaluated and scored. The evaluation process will be comprehensive and rigorous, taking into account a range of weighted criteria, required and optional capabilities, non-negotiables, and qualitative factors.

A. Weighted Criteria

Proposals will be evaluated based on the following weighted criteria:

Technical Capability (30%): This includes the ability to meet the technical requirements outlined in the RFP, as well as the quality of the proposed technical solution.

Pricing Competitiveness (30%): This refers to the competitiveness of the proposed pricing structure, including the overall cost, value for money, and alignment with the budget specified in the RFP.

Delivery Reliability (20%): This includes the reliability and feasibility of the proposed delivery schedule, as well as the vendor's track record of meeting delivery commitments.

Quality Assurance (15%): This refers to the quality of the proposed product or service, including compliance with industry standards and the effectiveness of the vendor's quality control processes.

Customer Service (5%): This includes the quality of the vendor's customer service, including responsiveness, communication, and problem-solving capabilities.

B. Required vs. Optional Capabilities

All proposals must meet the required capabilities outlined in the RFP. Proposals that also meet optional capabilities will be given additional consideration during the evaluation process.

C. Non-Negotiables

The following are non-negotiable requirements for this RFP:

1. The vendor must be able to deliver to Buffalo, New York.
2. The product must meet the specification: 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheet.
3. The pricing must be competitive and within the budget range of \$50 - \$700.

Proposals that do not meet these non-negotiable requirements will not be considered.

D. Qualitative Factors

In addition to the above criteria, proposals will also be evaluated based on qualitative factors such as the vendor's reputation, commitment to innovation, and alignment with our company's values and strategic objectives.

Please note that the evaluation process will be conducted in a fair and transparent manner, with all proposals being treated equally. The decision of the evaluation committee will be final.

C	Weight (%)

| Technical_capability | 30% |

| Pricing_competitiveness | 30% |

| Delivery_reliability | 20% |

| Quality_assurance | 15% |

| Customer_service | 5% |

Non-negotiables:

Must be able to deliver to Buffalo, New York

Product must meet specification: 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheet

Pricing must be competitive and within budget: \$50 - \$700

6. Pricing Details

Section IV: Pricing Details

The purpose of this section is to provide detailed instructions to all vendors on how to structure their pricing in response to this Request for Proposal (RFP).

Pricing Format and Currency

All vendors are required to provide their pricing in a detailed line-item breakdown format. This should include unit costs and quantities for each item or service provided. All prices should be quoted in United States Dollars (USD).

Contract Length Expectations

The contract length for this project is expected to be 1 year. Vendors should structure their pricing to reflect this duration.

Required Cost Categories

Vendors are required to provide pricing for the following cost categories:

1. Unit price for 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheet
2. Shipping and logistics to Buffalo, New York
3. Taxes and duties
4. Quality inspection fees (if applicable)
5. Rush delivery fees (if applicable)

Please note that all applicable taxes, duties, and fees should be included in the pricing.

Volume Discounts

If applicable, vendors should provide information on any volume discounts available. This should be clearly indicated in the pricing breakdown.

Budget Range and Payment Terms

The budget range for this project is between \$50 and \$700. Vendors are expected to provide competitive pricing within this range. The payment terms for this project are Net 30 days from delivery and acceptance.

Please ensure that all pricing is clear, precise, and standardized. Any pricing that does not adhere to the requirements outlined in this section may result in the vendor's proposal being deemed non-responsive.

Pricing Guidelines:

- Currency: USD
- Contract Length: 1 year
- Required cost categories:

Unit price for 7075-T6 Aluminum Sheet

Shipping and logistics to Buffalo, New York

Taxes and duties

Quality inspection fees (if applicable)

Rush delivery fees (if applicable)

Volume discounts (if applicable)

Submission Instructions

- **Deadline:** TBD

- **Delivery:** procurement@nexa.org